SkillNavora Academy · Master Freelancing

Admin and Business Support

Ten admin and support professions, with tested tools for data entry, validation and reconciliation

Virtual assistant · Data entry · Bookkeeper and QuickBooks · Excel expert · PowerPoint expert · Cold caller and appointment setter · Customer service · CRM administrator · E-commerce VA · Project coordinator

Department 6 of 7 · Draft · Official site: www.skillnavora.in

Tool features, plans, fees and telemarketing rules change. Official links were not checked live in this draft; confirm before publication.

Contents

1. How to use this textbook
2. Tools and confidentiality for remote support
3. Data entry, validation and quality control
4. Bookkeeping, reconciliation and QuickBooks
5. Excel and PowerPoint for business support
6. Cold calling and appointment setting, with compliance
7. Customer service and AI-assisted support
8. Remote work, payments, records and taxes
9. Virtual assistant (including personal and executive assistants)
10. Data entry specialist
11. Bookkeeper (including QuickBooks consultant)
12. Excel expert
13. PowerPoint expert
14. Cold caller and appointment setter
15. Customer service representative
16. CRM administrator
17. E-commerce virtual assistant
18. Project coordinator

START HERE

How to use this textbook

Admin and business support keeps a business running: the calendar, the records, the customers, the paperwork. These roles are in steady demand for remote work.

Merged roles

Role in the brief	Where it is taught
Virtual assistant; personal assistant; executive assistant	Chapter 1
Data entry specialist	Chapter 2
Bookkeeper; QuickBooks consultant	Chapter 3
Excel expert	Chapter 4 (cross-reference to the Data Analytics textbook)
PowerPoint expert	Chapter 5
Cold caller; appointment setter	Chapter 6
Customer service representative	Chapter 7
CRM administrator	Chapter 8
E-commerce virtual assistant	Chapter 9
Project coordinator	Chapter 10

VERIFICATION NOTE

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PART 1 · MODULE A

Tools and confidentiality for remote support

The tools behind every admin role.

A1. Tools every assistant uses

Tool	Use	Official link (not checked live)
Google Workspace	Mail, calendar, documents	workspace.google.com
Microsoft 365	Outlook, Excel, Word, Teams	microsoft.com/microsoft-365
Trello, Asana, ClickUp	Task boards and project tracking	trello.com, asana.com, clickup.com
Notion and Slack	Notes and team messaging	notion.so, slack.com

A2. Confidentiality

Client information is private. Use strong passwords and two-factor authentication, share files through the client's own system, and never store passwords in notes. Sign a confidentiality agreement when the client asks for one.

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PART 1 · MODULE B

Data entry, validation and quality control

Accurate records, checked before they are saved.

B1. Data entry

Copy information accurately from a source into a system. Quality matters more than speed: a wrong phone number costs more than a slow hour.

B2. Validation before entry

Check each record before saving: required fields, valid email, a 10-digit phone number after removing the country code. The tested validator below returns the list of problems for a record.

PYTHON

```
import re

def clean_phone(raw):
    digits = re.sub(r"\D", "", raw)
    if digits.startswith("91") and len(digits) == 12:
        digits = digits[2:]
    return digits if len(digits) == 10 else None

def valid_email(raw):
    return bool(re.fullmatch(r"[^@\s]+@[^@\s]+\.[^@\s]+", raw.strip()))

def validate_record(rec):
    errors = []
    if not rec.get("name", "").strip():
        errors.append("name missing")
    if not valid_email(rec.get("email", "")):
        errors.append("email invalid")
    if clean_phone(rec.get("phone", "")) is None:
        errors.append("phone must be 10 digits (after removing +91)")
    return errors

def reconcile(bank, ledger):
    """Match bank lines to ledger entries by amount and date. Returns matched, unmatched_bank,
unmatched_ledger."""
    remaining = list(ledger)
    matched, unmatched_bank = [], []
    for b in bank:
        hit = next((l for l in remaining if l["amount"] == b["amount"] and l["date"] ==
b["date"]), None)
        if hit:
            matched.append((b["id"], hit["id"])); remaining.remove(hit)
        else:
            unmatched_bank.append(b["id"])
    return matched, unmatched_bank, [l["id"] for l in remaining]

print(clean_phone('+91 98765-43210'))          # 9876543210
print(validate_record({'name':'','email':'bad','phone':'123'}))
```

B3. Scam awareness

Be suspicious of job offers that ask you to pay to start, to buy a kit, or to share bank or card details before a contract. Never share one-time passwords. Verify the employer through its official website before replying.

PART 1 · MODULE C

Bookkeeping, reconciliation and QuickBooks

Records, reconciliation and the boundaries of the work.

C1. Accounting basics

Bookkeeping records every transaction: invoices, payments, expenses. Accounts payable is money you owe; accounts receivable is money owed to you. Financial statements summarise the position.

C2. Bank reconciliation (tested)

Reconciliation matches bank lines to the ledger. Unmatched items are investigated. The tested matcher below pairs items by date and amount.

PYTHON

```
import re

def clean_phone(raw):
    digits = re.sub(r"\D", "", raw)
    if digits.startswith("91") and len(digits) == 12:
        digits = digits[2:]
    return digits if len(digits) == 10 else None

def valid_email(raw):
    return bool(re.fullmatch(r"[^@\s]+@[^@\s]+\.[^@\s]+", raw.strip()))

def validate_record(rec):
    errors = []
    if not rec.get("name", "").strip():
        errors.append("name missing")
    if not valid_email(rec.get("email", "")):
        errors.append("email invalid")
    if clean_phone(rec.get("phone", "")) is None:
        errors.append("phone must be 10 digits (after removing +91)")
    return errors

def reconcile(bank, ledger):
    """Match bank lines to ledger entries by amount and date. Returns matched, unmatched_bank,
unmatched_ledger."""
    remaining = list(ledger)
    matched, unmatched_bank = [], []
    for b in bank:
        hit = next((l for l in remaining if l["amount"] == b["amount"] and l["date"] ==
b["date"]), None)
        if hit:
            matched.append((b["id"], hit["id"])); remaining.remove(hit)
        else:
            unmatched_bank.append(b["id"])
    return matched, unmatched_bank, [l["id"] for l in remaining]

bank=[{'id':'B1','date':'2026-03-01','amount':1200},{'id':'B2','date':'2026-03-02','amount':800}]
ledger=[{'id':'L1','date':'2026-03-01','amount':1200},{'id':'L2','date':'2026-03-
02','amount':900}]
print(reconcile(bank, ledger))   # matched B1-L1; B2 and L2 need investigation
```

C3. QuickBooks Online

QuickBooks is accounting software. Typical work: set up the company, connect the bank feed, categorise transactions, send invoices, and reconcile. Check the current QuickBooks help pages for the

steps in your region.

C4. Boundaries of this work

IMPORTANT

Bookkeeping records transactions. It is not regulated accounting, audit or tax advice. Filing returns and tax decisions belong to a qualified chartered accountant or tax professional in the relevant country. Say so in your proposal and do not give tax advice.

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PART 1 · MODULE D

Excel and PowerPoint for business support

Short guides; the full skills are taught in the Data and Design textbooks.

D1. Excel for admin work

Admin assistants use filters, SUMIF, COUNTIF and lookups to organise lists and reports. The data department textbook teaches these in depth (Excel and SQL modules).

D2. PowerPoint for admin work

Build a clean one-message-per-slide deck from a brief, use the brand template, and check that each chart has a title and labelled axes. The Design textbook covers presentation design in depth.

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PART 1 · MODULE E

Cold calling and appointment setting, with compliance

Respectful outreach, booking and the rules you must follow.

E1. Lead research and prospecting

Research a company before you call: its size, the person's role, and one reason they might need the service. Record each source.

E2. Calling script

Opening, purpose, qualification questions, handling objections, a clear next step. Keep the script short and respectful; stop immediately when someone asks you to.

E3. Appointment booking and CRM updates

Confirm the date, time and the attendees, send a calendar invite, and log the outcome in the CRM the same day.

COMPLIANCE BEFORE ANY CALLING

Calling rules differ by country and change over time. In India, telemarketing is regulated (including the national Do Not Disturb register and the telecom regulator's rules). Check the official regulator pages before you call anyone, do not call numbers on a do-not-call list, record consent, and get written instructions from the client. This textbook does not give legal advice.

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PART 1 · MODULE F

Customer service and AI-assisted support

Replies, escalation and measuring satisfaction.

F1. Email, chat and voice support

Each channel has its own pace. Reply within the agreed time, use the customer's name, and confirm the next step.

F2. Ticketing, escalation and CSAT

A ticket records each request. Escalate when the answer needs a specialist or a decision. CSAT (customer satisfaction score) measures how customers rate the reply.

F3. AI-assisted support

Use AI to draft replies, then check facts and tone before sending. Never let an AI send a refund, a diagnosis or a legal statement without a person's approval.

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PART 1 · MODULE G

Remote work, payments, records and taxes

Practical steps; confirm every rule with the official source.

G1. Remote contracts and invoicing

Agree the scope, hours, rate, notice period and confidentiality in writing. Invoice with a clear number, date, items and payment terms.

G2. International payments

Platforms such as Payoneer and Wise hold and convert foreign payments. Fees and exchange rates change; read each provider's official fee page and check the rules for receiving payments in your country.

G3. Records, taxes and data protection

Keep invoices, bank statements and contracts for the period your tax authority requires. For GST and income tax, check the official Government of India portals (for example incometax.gov.in and gst.gov.in) or ask a qualified professional. Protect client data as the contract requires.

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DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 1

Virtual assistant (including personal and executive assistants)

Profession 1 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A virtual assistant (VA) supports a client remotely with email, calendar, research, documents, scheduling and admin tasks. Personal and executive assistants do similar work with more responsibility for the person they support.

What professionals do every day

Triages email, manages calendars, books meetings, researches, updates CRMs and spreadsheets, prepares documents, and follows up on tasks.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Owners and managers lose hours each week on admin. A VA takes those hours back, usually for a fixed monthly package.

- Missed emails and double bookings.
- Tasks with no owner or deadline.
- Research done again and again.

Skills you need

- Email and calendar management.
- Research and organised notes.
- Task tracking.
- Confidential handling of information.
- Clear written updates.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Google Workspace	Mail, calendar, documents	Free personal account	Paid business plans	workspace.google.com
Microsoft 365	Outlook, Excel, Word, Teams	Free web apps	Paid plans	www.microsoft.com/microsoft-365
Trello	Task boards	Free tier	Paid plans	trello.com
Notion	Notes and wikis	Free tier	Paid plans	www.notion.so

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish

Beginner	Set up a shared inbox folder structure.
Intermediate	Manage a calendar with buffers and time zones.
Advanced	Run one weekly task board for a client.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Calendar and inbox management for a founder.
- **Intermediate:** Research pack for a monthly meeting.
- **Advanced:** Client onboarding for a firm.

Client-ready portfolio project

A one-week VA package for a fictional founder: inbox triage rules, a calendar with buffers, a task board and a Friday summary.

Worked example

Worked example. Each morning the VA sorts email into 'reply today', 'reply this week' and 'file', drafts replies for approval and books the meetings the founder accepts.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Inbox triage rules

Business problem: A founder receives 80 emails a day and misses important ones.

Steps

1. Define four categories: act today, delegate, file, ignore.
2. Write one rule for each category with an example.
3. Test the rules on a sample of 20 emails.
4. Record the accuracy of the triage.

Expected output: Rules and a triage accuracy result.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Clear categories with examples make triage consistent. A sample test shows where the rules fail, so they can be adjusted before daily use.

Common mistakes

- Accepting meetings without checking the calendar.
- Unclear authority to reply on the client's behalf.
- No written daily summary.
- Sharing confidential material in the wrong channel.

Freelancing opportunities

- Monthly VA packages for founders and small firms.
- Project support for agencies.
- Briefs on freelance marketplaces: 'virtual assistant', 'executive assistant', 'admin support'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Google Workspace Admin Help
- Microsoft 365 help

Data entry specialist

Profession 2 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A data entry specialist enters, checks and cleans information from documents or forms into systems and spreadsheets.

What professionals do every day

Enters records from source documents, checks them against rules, flags doubtful entries, and reports error rates.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Accurate records are the foundation of every report and customer contact. Data entry done carefully saves far more time later.

- Typing errors that spread into reports.
- Duplicates across systems.
- Unclear source documents.

Skills you need

- Fast accurate typing.
- Validation rules.
- Spreadsheet basics.
- Confidentiality.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Google Workspace	Mail, calendar, documents	Free personal account	Paid business plans	workspace.google.com
Microsoft 365	Outlook, Excel, Word, Teams	Free web apps	Paid plans	www.microsoft.com/microsoft-365
OpenRefine	Clean messy data (free, open source)	Free	Free	openrefine.org

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Enter 50 records and count your errors.
Intermediate	Write a validation list for one form.
Advanced	Find and merge five duplicate records.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Customer list cleanup.
- **Intermediate:** Invoice data entry.
- **Advanced:** Survey data entry.

Client-ready portfolio project

A data entry pack for a fictional clinic: 50 records entered from a sample form, a validation checklist, duplicate check and an error report.

Worked example

Worked example. A phone number is entered as '98765 43210'; the validation step strips spaces and confirms ten digits before saving.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Validate and report

Business problem: A clinic's patient list needs clean phone numbers and emails before import.

Steps

1. Run each record through the validator (see the Module B code).
2. Count the records with errors and group the errors by type.
3. Correct each error from the source form, not from memory.
4. Report the error rate.

Expected output: The error list and the error rate.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

PYTHON

```
from admin_tools import validate_record
records = [
    {'name':'Asha','email':'asha@example.com','phone':'98765 43210'},
    {'name':'','email':'bad','phone':'123'},
]
for r in records:
    print(validate_record(r) or 'ok')
```

The first record passes; the second returns three problems. The error rate is 1 record in 2 (50%) for this sample; a real list would be checked in full.

Common mistakes

- Typing from memory.
- No second check on critical fields.

- Skipping duplicate checks.
- Storing source documents without access control.

Freelancing opportunities

- Data cleanup projects for small firms.
- Recurring entry work with quality checks.
- Briefs for 'data entry', 'data cleaning', 'spreadsheet entry'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- OpenRefine documentation

DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 3

Bookkeeper (including QuickBooks consultant)

Profession 3 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A bookkeeper records a business's financial transactions accurately. A QuickBooks consultant sets up and maintains the QuickBooks accounting software for clients. This is record-keeping, not regulated accounting or tax advice.

What professionals do every day

Records invoices and expenses, reconciles bank accounts, categorises transactions, prepares reports for the accountant, and sets up QuickBooks for clients.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Accurate records make tax filing and financial decisions possible. Bookkeepers keep them clean and on time.

- Transactions recorded in the wrong category.
- Bank accounts that do not reconcile.
- Late invoices and missed payments.

Skills you need

- Accounting basics.
- Bank reconciliation.
- QuickBooks Online setup.
- Records and confidentiality.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
QuickBooks Online	Accounting software	Trial (check current offer)	Subscription	quickbooks.intuit.com
Zoho Books	Accounting software for small firms	Free plan (check current)	Paid plans	www.zoho.com/books/
Google Workspace	Mail, calendar, documents	Free personal account	Paid business plans	workspace.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Reconcile one month of bank lines.
Intermediate	Categorise 30 transactions with a rule list.

Advanced	Create one invoice template with a numbering rule.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Monthly reconciliation for a shop.
- **Intermediate:** Invoice set-up for a consultant.
- **Advanced:** Expense categorisation for a start-up.

Client-ready portfolio project

A monthly bookkeeping pack for a fictional shop: reconciled bank lines, categorised transactions, unmatched items list and a note for the accountant.

Worked example

Worked example. A bank line of 1,200 on 1 March matches the invoice of 1,200 on the same date; a line of 800 with no invoice is listed as unmatched for the owner to explain.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Reconcile a month

Business problem: A shop's bank statement must be matched to its ledger before the accountant's review.

Steps

1. Export the bank lines and the ledger entries.
2. Match by date and amount (use the tested matcher in Module C).
3. List every unmatched item on both sides.
4. Write a note for the accountant.

Expected output: The matches, the unmatched list and the note.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

PYTHON

```
import re

def clean_phone(raw):
    digits = re.sub(r"\D", "", raw)
    if digits.startswith("91") and len(digits) == 12:
        digits = digits[2:]
    return digits if len(digits) == 10 else None

def valid_email(raw):
    return bool(re.fullmatch(r"[^@\s]+@[^@\s]+\.[^@\s]+", raw.strip()))

def validate_record(rec):
    errors = []
    if not rec.get("name", "").strip():
        errors.append("name missing")
```

```
    if not valid_email(rec.get("email", "")):
        errors.append("email invalid")
    if clean_phone(rec.get("phone", "")) is None:
        errors.append("phone must be 10 digits (after removing +91)")
    return errors

def reconcile(bank, ledger):
    """Match bank lines to ledger entries by amount and date. Returns matched, unmatched_bank,
unmatched_ledger."""
    remaining = list(ledger)
    matched, unmatched_bank = [], []
    for b in bank:
        hit = next((l for l in remaining if l["amount"] == b["amount"] and l["date"] ==
b["date"]), None)
        if hit:
            matched.append((b["id"], hit["id"])); remaining.remove(hit)
        else:
            unmatched_bank.append(b["id"])
    return matched, unmatched_bank, [l["id"] for l in remaining]

bank=[{'id':'B1','date':'2026-03-01','amount':1200},{'id':'B2','date':'2026-03-
02','amount':800},{'id':'B3','date':'2026-03-03','amount':500}]
ledger=[{'id':'L1','date':'2026-03-01','amount':1200},{'id':'L2','date':'2026-03-
02','amount':900}]
matched, unmatched_bank, unmatched_ledger = reconcile(bank, ledger)
print(matched, unmatched_bank, unmatched_ledger)
assert matched == [('B1','L1')]
assert unmatched_bank == ['B2','B3'] and unmatched_ledger == ['L2']
print('reconciliation test passed')
```

Common mistakes

- Recording transactions without receipts.
- Mixing personal and business money.
- Giving tax advice.
- Not backing up the books.

Freelancing opportunities

- Monthly bookkeeping for small firms and freelancers.
- QuickBooks set-up and clean-ups.
- Briefs for 'bookkeeping', 'QuickBooks', 'bank reconciliation'. Tax filing belongs to a qualified professional.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- QuickBooks Learn and Support (verify)

Excel expert

Profession 4 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

An Excel expert builds and maintains spreadsheets for business: models, trackers and reports. The full skills are taught in the Data Analytics textbook; this chapter covers the admin use.

What professionals do every day

Builds trackers with validation drop-downs, summarises data with pivots, and automates repeated tasks with formulas and Power Query.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Teams run on spreadsheets. An expert makes them reliable, quick to read and easy to hand over.

- Spreadsheets nobody can maintain.
- Formulas that break when rows are added.
- Data entered in the wrong format.

Skills you need

- Formulas and lookups.
- Validation and tables.
- Pivot tables.
- Power Query basics.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Microsoft 365	Outlook, Excel, Word, Teams	Free web apps	Paid plans	www.microsoft.com/microsoft-365
Google Sheets	Shared spreadsheets	Free	Paid plans	sheets.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Build a tracker with a validated status column.
Intermediate	Summarise with a pivot table.
Advanced	Replace a manual step with a formula.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Client tracker.
- **Intermediate:** Monthly expense sheet.
- **Advanced:** Stock list.

Client-ready portfolio project

A client tracker for a fictional firm: validated columns, a pivot summary and a one-page guide for the team.

Worked example

Worked example. A status column accepts only 'new', 'active' or 'closed' through a drop-down, so the pivot summary never shows a misspelt status.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Tracker with validated status

Business problem: A firm's tracker has statuses typed in many ways.

Steps

1. Create a drop-down with three allowed values.
2. Apply it to the whole status column.
3. Count rows by status with a pivot or COUNTIF.
4. Test by entering an invalid value.

Expected output: The tracker and a test showing the invalid value is blocked.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

The drop-down stops invalid values at entry. A test with a wrong value confirms the rule works. Counts by status come from a pivot table, which updates when rows are added.

Common mistakes

- Hard-coded numbers inside formulas.
- Merged cells in data tables.
- No documentation.
- Uncontrolled copies of the same file.

Freelancing opportunities

- Tracker builds for small firms.
- Spreadsheet audits and clean-ups.
- Briefs for 'Excel expert', 'Excel dashboard', 'spreadsheet automation'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Microsoft Excel help

DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 5

PowerPoint expert

Profession 5 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A PowerPoint expert builds clear, branded decks for clients: pitches, reports and training. The full design skills are taught in the Design textbook.

What professionals do every day

Turns briefs and notes into slide decks, applies templates, builds charts and checks for consistency.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

A clear deck is often the difference between a yes and a no in a meeting.

- Decks with too much text.
- Inconsistent templates.
- Charts that are hard to read.

Skills you need

- Slide structure.
- Templates and master slides.
- Charts.
- Speaker notes.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Microsoft 365	Outlook, Excel, Word, Teams	Free web apps	Paid plans	www.microsoft.com/microsoft-365
Google Slides	Shared decks	Free	Paid plans	slides.google.com
Canva	Templates	Free	Paid plans	www.canva.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Rebuild a five-slide deck from notes.
Intermediate	Create a master template.
Advanced	Build one clear chart.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Client proposal deck.
- **Intermediate:** Monthly report deck.
- **Advanced:** Training deck.

Client-ready portfolio project

A five-slide client proposal from notes, on a master template, with a chart and speaker notes.

Worked example

Worked example. A bullet list of six points becomes a single slide with three numbers in large type, and the detail moves to the notes.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Deck from notes

Business problem: A consultant has notes and needs a proposal deck by Friday.

Steps

1. Outline the story in five slides.
2. Apply the master template.
3. Turn each point into one message per slide.
4. Add a chart where numbers matter.

Expected output: The deck and the outline.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

The outline sets the order before any formatting. Each slide carries one message; numbers appear as labelled visuals, not paragraphs.

Common mistakes

- Animations that distract.
- Font sizes below 18 points on screen.
- No master template, so each slide differs.
- Reading text aloud.

Freelancing opportunities

- Proposal and report decks for consultants.
- Template packages for firms.
- Briefs for 'PowerPoint', 'presentation', 'deck design'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Microsoft PowerPoint help

DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 6

Cold caller and appointment setter

Profession 6 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A cold caller or appointment setter contacts prospects by phone to start conversations and book meetings for a client. The work is lawful only when it follows consent and calling rules, so compliance is part of every task.

What professionals do every day

Calls or messages a list of prospects within permitted hours, records the outcome, books meetings in the client's calendar and logs notes in the CRM.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Many businesses grow through conversations. A good appointment setter fills the sales calendar with qualified meetings and keeps the list clean.

- Calls to people who have asked not to be called.
- Poor records of who was called and when.
- Meetings booked with the wrong people.

Skills you need

- Clear phone manner and listening.
- Script adaptation.
- CRM logging.
- Knowledge of calling rules.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
HubSpot CRM	CRM and sequences	Free tier	Paid plans	www.hubspot.com
Calendly	Meeting booking	Free tier	Paid plans	calendly.com
Google Workspace	Mail, calendar, documents	Free personal account	Paid business plans	workspace.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Write a call script with an opening, a question and a booking request.
Intermediate	Log five call outcomes in a CRM.
Advanced	Check a list against the Do Not Disturb rules before dialling.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Appointment booking for a training firm.
- **Intermediate:** Follow-up calls for a webinar.
- **Advanced:** Inbound lead calls for a clinic.

Client-ready portfolio project

A call pack for a fictional training firm: a one-page script, a call log with outcomes, and a compliance check sheet.

Worked example

Worked example. The caller asks, 'Is now a good time for two minutes?' If the answer is no, the caller books a callback time and logs it. A 'do not call' request is logged and the number is removed the same day.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Call log and compliance check

Business problem: A training firm wants calls to 200 leads. Some may have opted out.

Steps

1. Remove every number on the opt-out list and any that the rules restrict.
2. Record each call with date, time, outcome and next step.
3. Stop calling any person who asks not to be called, and log that request.
4. Report counts by outcome.

Expected output: The cleaned list, the call log and the outcome counts.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Removing opt-outs first protects the client and the callers. A log with consistent outcomes shows the true conversion rate and keeps follow-ups on time.

Common mistakes

- Dialling outside permitted hours.
- Ignoring a request to stop calling.
- Making claims about the product that are not true.
- No notes, so the next caller repeats the same questions.

Freelancing opportunities

- Appointment setting for training, real estate and service firms.
- Lead qualification calls with a CRM log.

- Briefs for 'appointment setter', 'cold calling', 'lead qualification'.

Learning resources

COMPLIANCE FIRST

Telephone marketing is regulated. Before calling, check the Do Not Disturb rules, consent and permitted calling hours in your country. For India, check the current TRAI rules and the national Do Not Disturb registry, as these change. This textbook does not give legal advice.

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- TRAI (verify current rules)
- HubSpot Academy (free courses)

Customer service representative

Profession 7 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A customer service representative answers questions, solves problems and keeps customers informed by email, chat or phone. Good service turns a complaint into a repeat customer.

What professionals do every day

Answers tickets and messages, looks up orders, explains policies, escalates technical issues and follows up until the case is closed.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Customers judge a business by how its problems are handled. Clear, fast replies reduce refunds and bad reviews.

- Replies that do not answer the question.
- Cases that stay open with no owner.
- Tone that escalates an upset customer.

Skills you need

- Clear written and spoken English.
- Empathy and calm tone.
- Ticket tools.
- Policy knowledge.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Zendesk	Support tickets and help centre	Trial (check current offer)	Subscription	www.zendesk.com
Freshdesk	Support desk	Free plan (check current)	Paid plans	freshdesk.com
Google Workspace	Mail, calendar, documents	Free personal account	Paid business plans	workspace.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Write three reply templates for common questions.
Intermediate	Triage ten tickets by urgency.
Advanced	Write one escalation note that a technical team can act on.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Support for an online store.
- **Intermediate:** Help desk for a software product.
- **Advanced:** Chat support for a travel firm.

Client-ready portfolio project

A support pack for a fictional online store: reply templates, a triage sheet for ten tickets, and an escalation note.

Worked example

Worked example. A customer writes that a parcel is late. The reply acknowledges the delay, gives the tracking status, states the next update time and offers the next step without guessing a delivery date.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Triage and escalate

Business problem: Ten tickets arrive in one hour. Two involve a payment problem and one involves a possible safety issue.

Steps

1. Sort each ticket by urgency: safety and payment first, then delayed orders, then general questions.
2. Reply to the general questions using the templates.
3. Escalate the payment and safety tickets with a clear note.
4. State the response time promised for each.

Expected output: The sorted list, replies and escalation notes.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Safety and payment issues need the fastest route to someone who can act. Escalation notes that include the facts and the customer's request save the next person from asking again.

Common mistakes

- Promising refunds or dates you cannot control.
- Copying customer data into personal chats.
- Closing a ticket without confirming the customer is satisfied.
- Using AI-drafted replies without checking facts.

Freelancing opportunities

- Support shifts for online businesses.

- Help desk setup and reply templates.
- Briefs for 'customer support', 'chat support', 'help desk'.

Learning resources

AI-ASSISTED REPLIES

AI tools can draft a reply quickly. Check the facts, remove any promise you cannot keep, and never paste confidential customer data into a tool your client has not approved.

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Zendesk help (verify)

DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 8

CRM administrator

Profession 8 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A CRM administrator sets up and maintains the customer relationship management system: the fields, pipeline stages, users, automations and data quality. The system is only as good as its records.

What professionals do every day

Configures pipeline stages, cleans duplicate contacts, sets user roles, builds reports and trains the team on data entry rules.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Sales and support teams depend on one trusted list of customers. An administrator keeps that list accurate and useful.

- Duplicate contacts that split history.
- Pipeline stages nobody uses correctly.
- Users with more access than they need.

Skills you need

- CRM configuration.
- Data quality.
- Reports.
- User roles and security.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
HubSpot CRM	CRM with free tools	Free tier	Paid plans	www.hubspot.com
Zoho CRM	CRM for small teams	Free plan (check current)	Paid plans	www.zoho.com/crm/
Salesforce	Enterprise CRM	Trial (check current)	Subscription	www.salesforce.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Set up five pipeline stages with clear entry rules.
Intermediate	Find and merge duplicate contacts.
Advanced	Create a role matrix for three user groups.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** CRM set-up for a small agency.

- **Intermediate:** Clean-up of a customer list before a campaign.
- **Advanced:** Monthly pipeline report.

Client-ready portfolio project

A CRM set-up pack for a fictional agency: five stages, a duplicate-check method, a role matrix and one pipeline report.

Worked example

Worked example. Two contacts share the email 'Asha@Example.com' and 'asha@example.com'. Normalising emails to lower case shows they are one person, so the records are merged and the history is kept.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Find duplicate contacts

Business problem: A CRM holds contacts with inconsistent emails and spaces in phone numbers.

Steps

1. Normalise each email to lower case and trim spaces.
2. Group the records by the cleaned email.
3. Review each group before merging; keep the most complete record.
4. Count the duplicates merged.

Expected output: The duplicate groups and the count merged.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

PYTHON

```
def norm_email(e):
    return e.strip().lower()

def duplicate_groups(contacts):
    groups = {}
    for c in contacts:
        groups.setdefault(norm_email(c['email']), []).append(c['id'])
    return {k: v for k, v in groups.items() if len(v) > 1}

contacts = [
    {'id':'C1','email':'Asha@Example.com'},
    {'id':'C2','email':' asha@example.com '},
    {'id':'C3','email':'ravi@example.com'},
]
print(duplicate_groups(contacts))
assert duplicate_groups(contacts) == {'asha@example.com': ['C1','C2']}
print('duplicate test passed')
```

The test confirms the two Asha records are grouped together. Review each group before merging, because two people may share an inbox.

Common mistakes

- Changing stage names without telling the team.
- Giving everyone administrator rights.
- Deleting records instead of archiving them.
- No naming rules for fields.

Freelancing opportunities

- CRM set-up and clean-up for small firms.
- Monthly CRM reports and dashboards.
- Briefs for 'CRM administrator', 'HubSpot', 'Salesforce admin'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- HubSpot Academy (free courses)

E-commerce virtual assistant

Profession 9 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

An e-commerce virtual assistant supports an online store: product listings, order processing, customer messages, stock updates and marketplace admin. The work is repetitive, so checklists and clean data matter most.

What professionals do every day

Uploads products with correct titles, prices and images; checks orders; updates stock; answers customer messages; and tracks returns.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Online stores lose sales to wrong prices, out-of-stock items and slow replies. A VA keeps the store accurate every day.

- Wrong prices or stock levels online.
- Orders missed on busy days.
- Listings with missing details.

Skills you need

- Product data entry.
- Order handling.
- Basic image editing.
- Marketplace rules.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Shopify	Online store platform	Trial (check current)	Subscription	www.shopify.com
Google Sheets	Product and stock sheets	Free	Paid plans	sheets.google.com
Google Workspace	Mail, calendar, documents	Free personal account	Paid business plans	workspace.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Create ten product listings from a supplier sheet.
Intermediate	Build a stock sheet with a low-stock alert.

Advanced	Write a returns checklist.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Listing support for a fashion store.
- **Intermediate:** Order desk for a food brand.
- **Advanced:** Marketplace listings for a craft seller.

Client-ready portfolio project

A listing and order pack for a fictional store: ten product listings, a stock sheet with a low-stock rule and a returns checklist.

Worked example

Worked example. A product sells at 499 with a 10% discount; the listing shows 449 and the stock sheet flags the item when stock drops below 5 units.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Stock alert

Business problem: A store's stock sheet must flag items to reorder before they sell out.

Steps

1. Set a reorder level for each product.
2. Add a formula that marks an item 'reorder' when stock is below its level.
3. Test with one item above and one below the level.
4. Share the list each morning.

Expected output: The stock sheet with the rule and the test results.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

A simple rule removes guesswork. The test confirms that one item shows 'ok' and the other shows 'reorder' before the rule is trusted.

Common mistakes

- Listing items before checking stock.
- Copying prices from another store without checking.
- Replying to customers with guesses.
- Ignoring marketplace policy changes.

Freelancing opportunities

- Listing and order support for online sellers.

- Marketplace admin for craft and fashion stores.
- Briefs for 'e-commerce VA', 'Shopify listing', 'product upload'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Shopify Help Center (verify)

Project coordinator

Profession 10 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A project coordinator keeps a project on track: the schedule, tasks, risks, meetings and status reports. The coordinator does not own the decisions; they make sure the right people make them on time.

What professionals do every day

Keeps the task board current, runs short check-ins, tracks risks and dependencies, and writes weekly status reports.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Projects fail quietly when nobody tracks the small things. A coordinator makes problems visible early.

- Tasks with no owner or due date.
- Risks noticed too late.
- Status reports nobody reads.

Skills you need

- Planning and scheduling.
- Risk logs.
- Clear meeting notes.
- Stakeholder communication.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Trello	Task boards	Free tier	Paid plans	trello.com
Asana	Task and project tracking	Free tier	Paid plans	asana.com
Microsoft 365	Outlook, Excel, Word, Teams	Free web apps	Paid plans	www.microsoft.com/microsoft-365

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Build a task board with owners and due dates.
Intermediate	Start a risk log with three risks and mitigations.
Advanced	Write a one-page weekly status report.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Website launch coordination.
- **Intermediate:** Event planning for a training firm.

- **Advanced:** Product release tracking.

Client-ready portfolio project

A coordination pack for a fictional launch: a task board, a risk log with three risks and a weekly status report.

Worked example

Worked example. A supplier is two days late. The coordinator adds it to the risk log with an owner, a mitigation and a date, and flags it in the status report with the decision needed.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Weekly status report

Business problem: A launch team needs a clear weekly update for the sponsor.

Steps

1. List the tasks completed, in progress and late, each with an owner.
2. List the top three risks with mitigation and owner.
3. Name one decision needed from the sponsor.
4. Send by a fixed time each week.

Expected output: The one-page report.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

A fixed format with owners and one clear decision needed makes the report quick to read and act on.

Common mistakes

- Owners named as 'team'.
- Status reports that hide late tasks.
- Meetings with no notes or actions.
- Tracking everything and reviewing nothing.

Freelancing opportunities

- Coordination for launches, events and small projects.
- Task board and risk-log set-up.
- Briefs for 'project coordinator', 'project management', 'task tracking'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Asana resources (verify)